

Roadside Assistance Guide

Here's the thing. When something goes wrong on the road, you don't want to waste time guessing what to do. This guide gives a clear plan so anyone can handle a breakdown calmly and get help fast.

1. What to Do First

If the vehicle starts acting up, don't push your luck.

- Slow down gently and move to the side of the road or a safe shoulder.
- Turn on hazard lights right away.
- If visibility is poor or it's dark, keep your parking lights on so the vehicle is easy to spot.
- Stay inside the vehicle unless it's unsafe, like near heavy traffic or a blind turn.

What this really means is: secure yourself first, then deal with the vehicle.

2. Quick Self-Check

Before calling for help, do a fast check. It saves time when explaining the issue.

- Does the engine still crank?
- Any unusual smells like burning, fuel, or hot oil?
- Are warning lights showing something specific?
- Any visible damage like a flat tire, leaking fluid, smoke, or loose parts?

You're not trying to fix things here, just gather clues.

3. When to Call Roadside Assistance

Use assistance immediately if you notice:

- Flat or blown tire
- Engine overheating
- Battery completely dead
- Electrical failure
- Locked out of vehicle
- Accident or impact
- Loud knocking, smoke, or any safety risk

Don't keep driving "just to reach home". Small issues become big ones fast.

4. Information You Should Have Ready

This makes the call smoother and faster:

- Your exact location (landmarks are fine if you don't know the road name)
- Vehicle model and registration
- Description of the issue
- Whether you're in a safe spot or need urgent traffic-side help
- Any passengers or special conditions (kids, elderly, night-time, weather issues)

5. While Waiting for Help

This part matters more than people expect.

- Stay inside with doors locked.
- If stepping out is necessary, stand away from traffic.
- Keep your phone charged—avoid streaming or unnecessary calls.
- If it's hot or cold, manage cabin temperature but don't run the engine continuously if something is wrong with it.
- Keep an eye on surroundings; roadside service will identify themselves before approaching.

6. After Help Arrives

- Explain the symptoms clearly and step back so the technician can inspect.
- If a tow is required, remove valuables from the car.
- Ask for the repair report or service slip, even for a quick fix.
- Confirm the destination workshop before the tow truck moves.

7. Preventing Future Breakdowns

A few habits save a lot of trouble:

- Check tire pressure every two weeks.
- Don't ignore warning lights.
- Keep the battery and charging system in good shape.
- Service the vehicle on time.
- Avoid running the tank near empty—it stresses the fuel pump.